



**International
Standard**

ISO/IEC 42006

**Information technology — Artificial
intelligence — Requirements
for bodies providing audit and
certification of artificial intelligence
management systems**

*Technologies de l'information — Intelligence artificielle —
Exigences pour les organismes procédant à l'audit et à la
certification des systèmes de gestion de l'intelligence artificielle*

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Foreword

ISO (the International Organization for Standardization) and IEC (the International Electrotechnical Commission) form the specialized system for worldwide standardization. National bodies that are members of ISO or IEC participate in the development of International Standards through technical committees established by the respective organization to deal with particular fields of technical activity. ISO and IEC technical committees collaborate in fields of mutual interest. Other international organizations, governmental and non-governmental, in liaison with ISO and IEC, also take part in the work.

The procedures used to develop this document and those intended for its further maintenance are described in the ISO/IEC Directives, Part 1. In particular, the different approval criteria needed for the different types of document should be noted. This document was drafted in accordance with the editorial rules of the ISO/IEC Directives, Part 2 (see www.iso.org/directives or www.iec.ch/members_experts/refdocs).

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This document was prepared by Joint Technical Committee ISO/IEC JTC 1, *Information technology*, Subcommittee SC 42, *Artificial Intelligence*.

Any feedback or questions on this document should be directed to the user's national standards body. A complete listing of these bodies can be found at www.iso.org/members.html and www.iec.ch/national-committees.

Introduction

A management system for organizations providing, developing or using artificial intelligence (AI) systems or placing them on the market as suppliers is set up according to ISO/IEC 42001. It entails, but is not limited to, various special aspects regarding the management of risks, data protection, data quality, information and cyber security, ethics as well as the validation and verification of algorithms. Also, the life cycle processes for traditional software systems need to include AI-specific life cycle characteristics defined in ISO/IEC 5338^[1] which can be considered.

The object of conformity assessment in ISO/IEC 42001 and the necessary combination and complex interface functions in a management system according to ISO/IEC 42001 result in specific requirements for the certification bodies and their processes when they certify such management systems. Certification bodies can use this document to perform their roles in the auditing and certification of organizations with AI management systems (AIMS).

The certification of a management system according to ISO/IEC 42001 can be embedded in a conformity assessment scheme for products, processes and services according to ISO/IEC 17065^[2] in support of ISO/IEC 17067,^[3] ISO/IEC 17030^[4] applies if it is intended to mark the AI product, process or service with a mark of conformity. The certification document(s) for the AI management system according to ISO/IEC 42001 can be utilised within a ISO/IEC 17065 scheme according to ISO/IEC 17065:2012, 7.4.5 to avoid double tests.

Accreditation bodies and peer assessors can use this document to assess the minimum requirements for personnel competence in certification bodies along with their certification processes.

Information technology — Artificial intelligence — Requirements for bodies providing audit and certification of artificial intelligence management systems

1 Scope

This document specifies additional requirements to ISO/IEC 17021-1. The requirements contained in this document, when implemented, support the demonstration of competence, consistency and reliability by the bodies performing auditing and certification of an artificial intelligence management system (AIMS) according to ISO/IEC 42001 for organizations that provide, develop or use AI systems.

Certification of AIMS is a third-party conformity assessment activity (as described in ISO/IEC 17000:2020, 4.5), and bodies performing this activity are third-party conformity assessment bodies.

This document also provides the necessary information and confidence to customers about the way certification has been granted.

NOTE This document can be used as a criteria document for accreditation or peer assessment.

2 Normative references

The following documents are referred to in the text in such a way that some or all of their content constitutes requirements of this document. For dated references, only the edition cited applies. For undated references, the latest edition of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

ISO/IEC 17000:2020, *Conformity assessment — Vocabulary and general principles*

ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, *Conformity assessment — Requirements for bodies providing audit and certification of management systems — Part 1: Requirements*

ISO/IEC 42001:2023, *Information technology — Artificial intelligence — Management system*

ISO/IEC 22989:2022, *Information technology — Artificial intelligence — Artificial intelligence concepts and terminology*

3 Terms and definitions

For the purposes of this document, the terms and definitions given in ISO/IEC 17000, ISO/IEC 17021-1, ISO/IEC 42001, ISO/IEC 22989 and the following apply.

ISO and IEC maintain terminology databases for use in standardization at the following addresses:

- ISO Online browsing platform: available at <https://www.iso.org/obp>
- IEC Electropedia: available at <https://www.electropedia.org/>

3.1 artificial intelligence management system AIMS

set of interrelated or interacting elements of an organization to establish policies and objectives, as well as processes to achieve those objectives, in the provision, development or use of an AI system

4 Principles

The principles of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 4 apply.

5 General requirements

5.1 Legal and contractual matters

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 5.1 apply.

5.2 Management of impartiality

5.2.1 General

The requirements of [5.2.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 5.2 apply.

5.2.2 Conflicts of interest

5.2.2.1 General

In addition to the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 5.2.5, certification bodies shall not provide consulting for management systems related to artificial intelligence, information security, data protection (e.g. in the form of an external data protection officer or data protection check) or risk management to their ISO/IEC 42001 certification clients.

5.2.2.2 Examples of activities without conflict of interest

Certification bodies particularly may carry out the following activities without them being considered as consultancy or having a potential conflict of interest:

- a) when arranging and participating as a lecturer in publicly available training courses (excluding inhouse trainings for organizations or client specific trainings) related to artificial intelligence management systems, management systems, or auditing, certification bodies provide only generic and publicly available information;
- b) activities preceding the audit to identify the object of certification only when the sole purpose of which is to determine the scope of the audit and the client's readiness for a certification audit at that scope.

5.2.2.3 Examples of activities with conflict of interest

In order to prevent potential conflict of interest when addressing the duties listed above, the certification body shall not perform at least the following:

- a) provide company-specific advice as consultancy service;
- b) conduct activities which themselves take the form of an audit or lead to recommendations or advice that would be contrary to [5.2.2.1](#), or justify a reduction of the ultimate time of the certification audit;
- c) recommend specific solutions or advice regarding AIMS, AI systems or AI-specific processes, services and products.

The certification body shall not carry out any internal audits for the client to be certified. The restriction on conducting internal audits shall not be circumvented by renaming the activity as inspection, assessment or similar.

NOTE Certification bodies can add value during certification and surveillance audits (e.g. by identifying opportunities for improvement, as they become evident during the audit, without recommending specific solutions) without it being considered as consultancy or having a potential conflict of interest.

5.3 Liability and financing

5.3.1 General

The requirements of [5.3.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 5.3 apply.

5.3.2 Liability

In addition to the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 5.3.1, certification bodies shall be able to demonstrate a contract with an insurance policy or an alternative mechanism. Either option shall provide an appropriate amount of cover (i.e. insured amount, limitation of liability) for personal injury, property damage and financial loss in proportion to the turnover (i.e. annual gross revenue) of the clients under audit or certification.

NOTE When determining the appropriate amount of insurance, the potential for damage to the certification body is relevant. The characteristics of the certification body's clients and their AI systems, which are the subject of the AIMS to be certified, have an influence on the certification body's damage potential. This is not product liability. The liability at issue here is exclusively intended to cover damages arising from the breach of organizational obligations resulting from non-compliance with ISO/IEC 42001 during certification.

6 Structural requirements

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 6 apply.

7 Resource requirements

7.1 Competence of personnel

7.1.1 General

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 7.1 apply. In addition, the technical competence requirements for the audit team and personnel involved in the AIMS certification process provided in [7.1.2](#) and [7.1.3](#) shall apply.

7.1.2 Generic technical competence requirements

The certification body shall define the competence requirements for each certification function as referenced in ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Table A.1. Basic knowledge of the client's business and typical business processes knowledge is defined in ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Table A.1.

[Table 1](#) specifies the additional knowledge and skills that a certification body shall define for the certification functions. "X" indicates that the certification body shall define the criteria and depth of knowledge and skills. The knowledge and skill requirements specified in [Table 1](#) are explained in more detail in [7.1.3](#) and are cross-referenced in parentheses in [Table 1](#).

In addition to the technical knowledge requirements specified in [Table 1](#), the certification body shall define criteria, including the knowledge and skills of the audit team that is necessary for the client organization and the technical area(s) regarding the scope of the client's AIMS.

Where additional specific criteria including competence requirements have been established in this document, a specific standard or certification scheme incorporating ISO/IEC 42001, these shall be applied.

NOTE 1 For an AIMS, the term "technical area" includes the products, processes and services in the scope of the AIMS certification. The technical area(s) are defined in terms of the technical fields of AI within the scope of certification (e.g. computer vision and image recognition, natural language processing (NLP), data mining, etc.), the application of the AI system(s) within the scope of certification (e.g. fraud detection, automated vehicles, healthcare, retail, etc.) or a combination of the two.

NOTE 2 Certification of an AIMS is based on multiple, diverse competencies which are potentially not present in one natural person. The certification body typically appoints and deploys competent people that fulfil all the required competence criteria as a competent group, if applicable, and throughout all functions of the certification process. The certification body determines separate characteristics for knowledge and skills, whereas skills are based on knowledge.

Table 1 — Table of knowledge and skills in addition to ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Annex A

Knowledge and skills	Certification function		
	Conducting the application review to determine audit team competence required, to select the audit team members, and to determine the audit time	Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions	Auditing and leading the audit team
General requirements for AIMS		X (7.1.3.1.2)	X (7.1.3.1.1)
Artificial intelligence management system standards/normative documents / certification schemes	X (7.1.3.2.3)	X (7.1.3.2.2)	X (7.1.3.2.1)
AI and AIMS related legal obligations	X (7.1.3.3.3)	X (7.1.3.3.2)	X (7.1.3.3.1)
Artificial intelligence and AIMS specific terminology, principles, practices, tools, methods and techniques	X (7.1.3.4.3)	X (7.1.3.4.2)	X (7.1.3.4.1)
Client business sector	X (7.1.3.5.3)	X (7.1.3.5.2)	X (7.1.3.5.1)
Client products, processes and organization		X (7.1.3.6.2)	X (7.1.3.6.1)

7.1.3 Specific technical competence requirements

7.1.3.1 General requirements for AIMS

7.1.3.1.1 Auditing

The certification body shall have criteria for verifying the competence of audit team members that ensures that at least they have the skills to apply their knowledge of:

- a) artificial intelligence;
- b) the technical aspects of the activity to be audited;
- c) management systems and business management practices, concepts and the interrelationship between policy, objectives and results;
- d) the principles of auditing;

NOTE Further information on the principles of auditing can be found in ISO 19011^[5].

- e) AIMS monitoring, measurement, analysis and evaluation.

The above requirements a) to e) apply to all individual auditors in the audit team. However, b) can be shared among members in the audit team.

The audit team members shall, collectively, have skills appropriate to the requirements above, which can be demonstrated through experience of their application.

The audit team members shall, collectively, be competent in tracing and identifying indications of incidents with serious negative effects on affected persons in the client's AIMS back to the appropriate elements of the AIMS.

Individual auditors are not required to have a complete range of experience of all areas of artificial intelligence, but the audit team as a whole shall have appropriate competence to cover the AIMS scope being audited.

7.1.3.1.2 Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions

The personnel responsible for reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions within the certification body shall have knowledge of the requirements of [7.1.3.1.1](#). This also applies for the team of personnel handling appeals.

7.1.3.2 Artificial intelligence management system standards/normative documents / certification schemes

7.1.3.2.1 Auditing

Each member of the audit team shall have knowledge of:

- a) ISO/IEC 42001 and other normative documents used in the certification process;
- b) AIMS-specific documentation structures, hierarchy and interrelationships;
- c) other normative documents used in the certification process;
- d) relevant certification schemes and necessary evaluation criteria for the conformity assessment.

The audit team members shall, collectively, have knowledge of all controls contained in ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A and their implementation.

7.1.3.2.2 Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions

Personnel reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions shall have knowledge of list items a) to d) in [7.1.3.2.1](#). This also applies for the team of personnel handling appeals.

7.1.3.2.3 Conducting the application review to determine the required audit team competence, to select the audit team members and to determine the audit time

The personnel responsible for conducting the application review, selecting the audit team, determining the needed audit competence and determining the audit time shall have knowledge of list items a) to d) in [7.1.3.2.1](#).

7.1.3.3 AI and AIMS related legal obligations

7.1.3.3.1 Auditing

The certification body audit team shall have knowledge of the legal obligations that apply to artificial intelligence.

7.1.3.3.2 Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions

Personnel reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions shall have knowledge of [7.1.3.3.1](#). This also applies for the team of personnel handling appeals.

7.1.3.3.3 Conducting the application review to determine the required audit team competence, to select the audit team members and to determine the audit time

The personnel responsible for conducting the application review, selecting the audit team, determining the needed audit competence and determining the audit time shall have knowledge of [7.1.3.3.1](#).

7.1.3.4 Artificial intelligence and AIMS specific terminology, principles, practices, tools, methods and techniques

7.1.3.4.1 Auditing

Each member of the audit team shall have knowledge of:

- a) generic concepts and terminology of AI based on ISO/IEC 22989 as well as on the AI system life cycle processes based on ISO/IEC 5338^[1];
- b) AIMS-specific documentation structures, hierarchy and interrelationships;
- c) processes applicable to AIMS;
- d) artificial intelligence management and governance structures including roles and responsibilities in the provision, development and use of an AI system;

The audit team members shall, collectively, have knowledge of:

- e) risk management processes, including assessment and mitigation procedures (in particular knowledge of ISO/IEC 23894^[6]);
- f) impact assessment, risk assessment, data quality, and bias related to artificial intelligence management, if applicable information and data security (in particular knowledge of ISO/IEC 22989, ISO/IEC 42005,^[7] ISO/IEC 23894,^[6] ISO/IEC 5259-3,^[8] ISO/IEC TR 24027:2021,^[9] ISO/IEC 27001,^[10] and ISO/IEC 27701^[11]).

7.1.3.4.2 Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions

Personnel reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions shall have knowledge of the list items a) to f) in [7.1.3.4.1](#). This also applies for the team of personnel handling appeals.

7.1.3.4.3 Conducting the application review to determine the required audit team competence, to select the audit team members and to determine the audit time

The personnel responsible for conducting the application review, selecting the audit team, determining the needed audit competence and determining the audit time shall have knowledge of list items a) to c) in [7.1.3.4.1](#).

7.1.3.5 Client business sector

7.1.3.5.1 Auditing

Each member of the audit team shall have knowledge of:

- a) generic terminology, processes, technologies and risks related to the client business sector;
- b) artificial intelligence management related tools, methods, techniques and their application;
- c) policies and business requirements for artificial intelligence management;
- d) relevant business sector practices;

The audit team members shall, collectively, have knowledge of:

- e) codes of conduct as well as good practices and procedures on trustworthy AI (e.g. related to ISO/IEC TR 24028^[12]) within the specific industry;
- f) software development processes.

7.1.3.5.2 Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions

Personnel reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions shall have knowledge of list items a) to f) in [7.1.3.5.1](#). This also applies for the team of personnel handling appeals.

7.1.3.5.3 Conducting the application review to determine the required audit team competence, to select the audit team members and to determine the audit time

The personnel responsible for conducting the application review, selecting the audit team, determining the needed audit competence and determining the audit time shall have knowledge of list item a) in [7.1.3.5.1](#).

7.1.3.6 Client products, processes and organization

7.1.3.6.1 Auditing

The audit team members shall, collectively, have knowledge of:

- a) the effect of organization type, governance, structure, functions and relationships on development and implementation of the AIMS and certification activities, including outsourcing;
- b) technologies (including algorithms), methods, processes and tools that encompass data science and the discipline of AI as well as specific AI processes such as machine learning.

7.1.3.6.2 Reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions

Personnel reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions shall have knowledge of list items a) to b) in [7.1.3.6.1](#). This also applies for the team of personnel handling appeals.

7.2 Personnel involved in the certification activities

7.2.1 General

The requirements of [7.2.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 7.2 apply.

7.2.2 Demonstration of knowledge and experience

7.2.2.1 General considerations

The certification body shall demonstrate that each auditor has acquired knowledge and skills through each of:

- a) recognized AIMS-specific qualifications;
- b) registration as an auditor, where applicable;
- c) participation in AIMS training courses, where applicable, and attainment of relevant personal qualifications;
- d) up-to-date professional development records;
- e) AIMS audits witnessed by another competent and authorized AIMS auditor, where applicable.

7.2.2.2 Selecting auditors

In addition to [7.1.2](#) and [7.1.3](#), the process for selecting auditors shall ensure that each auditor:

- a) has professional education or training to an equivalent level of university education;
- b) has at least four years of full-time practical workplace experience in information technology or data protection and at least one year related to AI systems;

- c) has successfully completed at least 24 hours of training that included AIMS audits and audit management. After the training, the trainee should be capable of applying and transforming their knowledge of ISO/IEC 19011^[5] and ISO/IEC 42006 on the specific certification case;
- d) has gained auditing experience prior to acting as an auditor for AIMS, evident by auditing management systems (such as but not limited to ISO 9001^[13] and ISO/IEC 27001^[10]). This experience shall have been gained in at least ten audit days or of at least three management system audits (stage 1 and stage 2) as auditor or auditor in-training, and the experience shall be performed in the last five years. This experience shall have been gained as an auditor under the supervision and evaluation of a more experienced auditor (see ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.2.2.1.4) in the course of participation in at least one initial certification or re-certification audit and at least one surveillance audit. The participation shall include review of documentation and risk assessment, implementation assessment, and audit reporting;
- e) maintains current knowledge related to AI systems and auditing through ongoing professional development and audits.

The criteria a) to e) also apply to the team of personnel reviewing audit reports and making certification decisions as well as to the team of personnel handling appeals.

NOTE The person responsible for the certification decision can have more general knowledge and does not need to have the same technical competencies as the person reviewing the audit report [especially no knowledge of list item b) to e)], as long as these functions are performed by different employees. Conversely, this means that the competencies for the assessment of the audit report apply, if the person responsible for reviewing the audit report and the person responsible for certification are the same person.

7.2.2.3 Selecting auditors for leading the team

In addition to 7.2.2.1 and 7.2.2.2, the criteria for selecting an auditor for leading the team shall ensure that the auditor has actively participated as auditor in all stages of at least three management system audits. The participation shall include initial scoping and planning, document review, review of risk assessment and its implementation, and formal audit reporting.

The audit team leader shall meet these requirements, through previous experience in supervised audits performed by an experienced AIMS auditor who has conducted at least three ISO/IEC 42001 audits.

For a transition period of up to two years after the year of publication of this standard, it is permissible to replace participation in at least three ISO/IEC 42001 (AIMS) audits with participation in at least three ISO/IEC 27001^[10] (ISMS) audits.

7.3 Use of individual external auditors and external technical experts

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 7.3 apply.

7.4 Personnel records

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 7.4 apply.

7.5 Outsourcing

Outsourcing in accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 7.5 is not permitted within the scope of certification according to ISO/IEC 42001.

8 Information requirements

8.1 Public information

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.1 apply.

8.2 Certification documents

8.2.1 General

The requirements of [8.2.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.2 apply.

8.2.2 AIMS certification documents

Certification documents shall be signed by the authorised person who has been assigned that responsibility and shall additionally to ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.2.2 entail the following:

- a) version of the statement of applicability (SoA) on which the certification is based;
- b) the information that the AIMS certificate does not authorize the labelling of products, processes and services.

A comprehensive example of all information within a certification document template is displayed in [Annex C](#).

8.3 Reference to certification and use of marks

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.3 apply.

8.4 Confidentiality

8.4.1 General

The requirements of [8.4.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.4 apply.

8.4.2 Access to the documentation of the organization

Prior to the certification audit, the certification body shall ask the client to report if any AIMS related information (such as AIMS records of information about design and effectiveness of controls or access to source code and raw data) cannot be made available for review by the audit team because it contains confidential or sensitive information. The certification body shall determine whether the AIMS can be adequately audited in the absence of such information. If the certification body concludes that it is not possible to adequately audit the AIMS without reviewing the identified confidential or sensitive information, it shall advise the client that the certification audit cannot take place until appropriate access arrangements are granted.

The certification body and the client shall mutually establish and implement safeguards for protected information or sensitive information, intellectual property, trade secrets and the technical means and infrastructures to be used in the certification agreement in accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 5.1.2.

8.5 Information exchange between a certification body and its clients

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.5 apply.

9 Process requirements

9.1 Pre-certification activities

9.1.1 General

The requirements of [9.1.2](#), [9.1.3](#), [9.1.4](#), [9.1.5](#), [9.1.6](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1 apply.

9.1.2 Audit programme

The requirements of [9.1.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1.3 apply.

The audit programme shall cover all applicable management system requirements and shall identify the stakeholder role(s) of the client organization.

NOTE 1 A client can occupy one or multiple roles. For example, a client can be an AI producer and AI customer or an AI provider and AI customer.

NOTE 2 Further guidance on stakeholder role(s) is given in ISO/IEC 22989.

9.1.3 Scope of certification

The certification body shall ensure that the client's definition of the certification scope includes all significant processes and risks relevant to the AI system and is reflected in the statement of applicability (SoA). The SoA defines the scope of certification.

9.1.4 Determining audit time

9.1.4.1 General

The requirements of [9.1.4.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1.4 apply.

9.1.4.2 Audit time

Certification bodies shall provide the audit team with sufficient time to perform all activities related to an initial certification audit, surveillance audit, or re-certification audit. The calculation of total audit time shall include sufficient time for audit reporting and for internal consultation within the audit team.

Additional time shall be scheduled and provided as needed for each nonconformity finding, separate from normal audit time calculations, to evaluate corrective actions, if needed.

The certification body shall use [9.1.4.](#) and [Annex A](#) to determine audit time requirements for the defined scope under ISO/IEC 42001. The specified audit times in [Annex A](#) relate to the activities of the audit team and potential technical experts on site. The allocation of audit time within the audit team is permitted, but not the reduction of the total audit time according to the calculation.

NOTE [Annex B](#) provides further guidance and examples on the calculation of audit time.

9.1.5 Multi-site sampling

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1.5 apply.

9.1.6 Multiple management systems

9.1.6.1 General

The requirements of [9.1.6.2](#), [9.1.6.3](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1.6 apply.

9.1.6.2 Integration of the AIMS documentation into the documentation for other management system

The certification body may accept documentation that is combined (e.g. for information security, privacy, risk management and quality) as long as the AIMS can be clearly identified together with the appropriate interfaces to the other systems.

9.1.6.3 Combining management system audits

The AIMS audit may be combined with audits of other management systems, provided that it can be demonstrated that the audit satisfies all requirements for certification of the AIMS. All the elements important to an AIMS shall appear clearly and be readily identifiable in the audit reports. The quality of the audit shall not be adversely affected by the combination of the audits.

9.2 Planning audits

9.2.1 Determining audit objectives, scope and criteria

9.2.1.1 General

The requirements of [9.2.1.2](#), [9.2.1.3](#), [9.2.1.4](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.2.1 apply.

9.2.1.2 Audit objectives

The audit objectives shall include:

- a) determining the effectiveness of the AI management system (AIMS);
- b) ensuring that the client, based on the risk assessment, has identified the necessary controls; and
- c) determining that the established AIMS objectives have been achieved.

9.2.1.3 Scope of audit

The audit team shall audit the AIMS of the client covered by the defined certification scope against all applicable certification requirements. The certification body shall confirm, in the scope of the client's AIMS, that the client addresses all requirements.

Certification bodies shall ensure that the risk assessment and risk treatment of the client's AI management system adequately reflects its activities and extends to the boundaries of the activities as defined in the scope of certification. Certification bodies shall confirm that this is reflected in the client's scope of their AIMS and statement of applicability (SoA). The certification body shall verify that there is at least one SoA per scope of certification.

Certification bodies shall ensure that interfaces to services or activities that are not entirely within the AIMS scope of applicability are addressed in the AIMS undergoing certification and have been included in the risk assessment of the client's artificial intelligence management system. An example of such a situation is the sharing of facilities on which the AI system runs or is interconnected (e.g. IT systems, databases and telecommunication systems or the outsourcing of a business function) with other organizations.

9.2.1.4 Audit criteria

The criteria against which the AIMS is audited shall be the AIMS standard ISO/IEC 42001. Other documents can be required for certification relevant to the function of the AIMS performed. In this context, all processes for regional and regulatory specificities covered by the AIMS will be reviewed and assessed by the certification body for suitability in stage 1 to enable an appropriate and risk-based selection of audit evidence for stage 2. The audit criteria may be expanded to include comparison of controls additional to ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A.

9.2.2 Audit team selection and assignments

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.2.2 apply.

9.2.3 Audit plan

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.2.3 apply.

9.2.4 Deployment of remote audit

Certification bodies intending to conduct remote audit activities shall define procedures to determine the level of remote audit activities ("remote audits") that can be applied to auditing a client's AIMS. The audit plan and audit report shall include clear indications if remote audit activities have been performed.

The procedures shall include analysis of the risks related to the use of remote auditing for the client, which shall consider the following factors:

- a) available infrastructure of the certification body and the client;
- b) sector in which the client operates;
- c) type(s) of audit during the certification cycle from initial audit to recertification audit;
- d) competence of the persons of the certification body and the client, who are involved in the remote audit;
- e) previously demonstrated performance of remote audits for the client;
- f) scope of the certification.

The analysis shall be performed prior to performing any remote audit. The analysis and the justification for use of remote audit during the certification cycle shall be documented.

Remote audits shall not be used if the risk assessment identifies unacceptable risks to the effectiveness of the audit process.

The risk assessment shall be reviewed during the certification cycle to ensure its continued suitability.

NOTE In case the client uses virtual sites (i.e. location where an organization performs work or provides a service using an online environment allowing persons involved to execute processes irrespective of physical locations), remote audit techniques are a relevant part of the audit plan.

9.3 Initial certification

9.3.1 General

The requirements of [9.3.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.3 apply.

9.3.2 Initial certification audit

9.3.2.1 Stage 1

In this stage of the audit, the certification body shall obtain documentation on the design of the AIMS that covers the documentation required by ISO/IEC 42001.

The certification body shall obtain a sufficient understanding of the design of the AIMS in the context of the client's organization, risk assessment and management (including defined measures), AI policy, and information security policy and objectives, and in particular the client's readiness for the audit. This will enable planning for stage 2.

The results of stage 1 shall be documented in a written report. The certification body shall review the stage 1 audit report before deciding on proceeding with stage 2. The certification body shall confirm that the stage 2 audit team members have the necessary competence. This may be done by the auditor leading the team that conducted the stage 1 audit if deemed competent and appropriate.

NOTE Independent review (i.e. by a person from the certification body not involved in the audit) is one measure to mitigate the risks involved when deciding if and with whom to proceed to stage 2. However, other risk mitigation measures can already be in place achieving the same goal.

The certification body shall make the client aware of the further types of information and records that can be required for detailed examination during stage 2.

9.3.2.2 Stage 2

Based on the findings documented in the stage 1 audit report, the certification body shall develop an audit plan for the conduct of stage 2 according to the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.3.1.3. In addition to evaluating the effective implementation of the AIMS, the objective of stage 2 is to confirm that the client adheres to its own policies, objectives and procedures.

9.4 Conducting audits

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.4. apply.

9.5 Certification decision

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.5 apply.

9.6 Maintaining certification

9.6.1 General

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.6.1 apply.

9.6.2 Surveillance activities

9.6.2.1 General

The requirements of [9.6.2.2](#) and of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.6.2 apply.

9.6.2.2 Surveillance audits

Surveillance audit procedures shall be consistent with those related to the certification audit of the client's organization as outlined in this document.

The purpose of surveillance is to verify that the organization continuously running an AIMS according to ISO/IEC 42001, to consider the effect of changes to that system made due to changes in the client's organization and to confirm continued compliance with the certification requirements.

The certification body shall adapt its surveillance programme to address AI system issues related to risks and effects to the client and justify that programme.

Surveillance audits may be combined with audits of other management systems. Reporting shall clearly identify the aspects relevant to each management system.

As part of surveillance audits, certification bodies shall review records of appeals and complaints submitted to the certification body. In cases of identified nonconformities, certification bodies shall verify that the client has investigated its own AIMS and procedures and taken appropriate corrective action.

A surveillance audit report shall include, in particular, information on the resolution of previously discovered nonconformities, as well as the version of the SoA and significant changes since the last audit.

9.6.3 Re-certification

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.6.3 apply.

9.6.4 Special audits

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.6.4 apply.

9.6.5 Suspending, withdrawing or reducing the scope of certification

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.6.5 apply.

9.7 Appeals

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.7 apply.

9.8 Complaints

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.8 apply.

9.9 Client records

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.9 apply.

10 Management system requirements for certification bodies

10.1 Options

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 10.1 apply.

10.2 Option A: General management system requirements

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 10.2 apply.

10.3 Option B: Management system requirements in accordance with ISO 9001

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 10.3 apply.

Annex A **(normative)**

Audit time

A.1 Criteria for determining audit time

This Annex contains further requirements related to ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1.4. This Annex provides minimum requirements and guidance for a certification body on the development of its own procedures for determining the amount of time required for the audits and certification of an organization running an AIMS and its determined scope based on differing sizes and complexity over a broad spectrum of activities.

This also includes the necessity to take the context of the AIMS and the actual effects on individuals, groups of individuals and societies regarding health and safety of an AI system into account which requires additive audit time.

Certification bodies shall allow auditors sufficient time to undertake all activities relating to an initial audit, surveillance audit or re-certification audit. The calculation of overall audit time shall include sufficient time for audit reporting.

The certification body shall identify the amount of audit time to be spent on initial certification, surveillance and re-certification for each client and certified AIMS. Using this [Annex A](#) at the audit-planning phase leads to a consistent approach to the determination of appropriate audit time. Additionally, the audit time can be adjusted based on what is found during the course of the audit, especially during stage 1 (e.g. different scopes and system impacts that affect the assessment of the complexity of the AIMS).

This Annex presents:

- concepts that are used for audit time calculation ([A.2](#));
- requirements for the procedures for determining audit time for the initial audit ([A.3](#); [A.6](#));
- requirements for audit time for surveillance monitoring ([A.4](#); [A.6](#));
- requirements for re-certification audit ([A.5](#); [A.6](#));
- requirements related to multi-site audits ([A.7](#));
- requirements for audit time for scope extension ([A.8](#); [A.6](#)).

Examples for audit time calculation to illustrate the application of [Annex A](#) can be found in [Annex B](#).

A basic assumption of this approach is that a calculation scheme for determining audit time should:

- a) consider only substantiated attributes that can be determined;
- b) be simple enough for certification bodies to apply and achieve valid comparable and reproducible results;
- c) be sophisticated enough to enable sufficient distinction between AIMS of differing complexity that culminates in comparable changes in the resulting audit time.

The determination of the audit time is based on the numbers provided in [Table A.1](#) ("Calculation of audit time for initial audit") below and shall consider contributing factors for modification.

The approach for determining audit time defined by the certification body shall be regularly reviewed to verify if it is sufficient for the complexity of the AIMS and for the actual effects on individuals, groups of individuals and societies.

A.2 Concepts

A.2.1 Number of persons involved in the AI life cycle

The total number of persons under the organization's control that are involved in the AI life cycle for all shifts is the starting point for determination of audit time.

NOTE Persons doing work under the organization's control that are involved in the AI life cycle includes the organization's own personnel and contract workers required to work in accordance with the requirements of the AIMS. Not included are external service provider.

Part-time persons doing work under the organization's control contribute to the total number of persons doing work under the organization's control by determining the number of hours worked compared to a full-time employee.

The certification body shall use the factors given in [A.3](#) and further consider the activities of the client's AIMS to determine audit time.

Coherent, consistent and repeatable procedure(s) that can be applied on a client-by-client basis shall be documented.

A.2.2 Adjustment of audit time by various factors

To determine sufficient time for performing audit activities, further factors shall be considered. Those factors depend on (external) factors such as but not limited to any applicable regulatory frameworks, the implementation of the managed AI systems within sensitive areas or third-party agreements relevant for AIMS.

A.2.3 Auditor day

"Audit time" as referenced in the chart is stated in terms of "auditor days" spent on the audit (abbreviated as "d"). The basis of the calculation of [Annex A](#) is an 8 h working day.

The allocation of audit time within the audit team is permitted, but not the reduction of the total audit time according to the calculation.

A.2.4 Remote methods for conducting audit

If remote auditing methods such as interactive web-based collaboration, web meetings, teleconferences and/or electronic verification of the organization's processes are utilized to interface with the organization, these activities should be identified in the audit plan (see [9.2.3](#)) and may be considered as partially contributing to the total "on-site audit time".

NOTE On-site audit time refers to the on-site audit time allocated for individual sites. Electronic audits of remote sites are considered to be remote audits, even if the electronic audits are physically carried out on the organization's premises.

A.3 Procedure for determining audit time for initial certification audit

A.3.1 General

The calculation of audit time shall follow a documented procedure.

Table A.1 — Calculation of audit time for initial audit

Number of persons involved in the AI life cycle (based on ISO/IEC 5338:2023 ^[1] / ISO/IEC 22989:2022)	AIMS roles				Further factors for adjustment	Total audit time
	Auditor days — AIMS for AI producer	Auditor days — AIMS for AI provider (≈ 2/3 of AIMS audit time for AI producer)	Auditor days — AIMS for AI user (≈ 2/3 of AIMS audit time for AI producer)	Auditor days — AIMS for clients with multiple roles (≈ 1/3 additional audit time of AIMS for AI producer)		
1 to 10	5.0	3.5	3.5	6.5	See A.3.2	
11 to 15	6.0	4.0	4.0	8.0	See A.3.2	
16 to 25	7.0	4.5	4.5	9.5	See A.3.2	
26 to 45	8.5	6.0	6.0	11.5	See A.3.2	
46 to 65	10.0	7.0	7.0	13.0	See A.3.2	
66 to 85	11.0	7.5	7.5	15.0	See A.3.2	
86 to 125	12.0	8.0	8.0	16.0	See A.3.2	
126 to 175	13.0	9.0	9.0	17.5	See A.3.2	
176 to 275	14.0	9.5	9.5	19.0	See A.3.2	
276 to 425	15.0	10.0	10.0	20.0	See A.3.2	
426 to 625	16.5	11.0	11.0	22.0	See A.3.2	
626 to 875	17.5	11.5	11.5	23.5	See A.3.2	
876 to 1 175	18.5	12.5	12.5	24.5	See A.3.2	
1 176 to 1 550	19.5	13.0	13.0	26.0	See A.3.2	
1 551 to 2 025	21.0	14.0	14.0	28.0	See A.3.2	
2 026 to 2 675	22.0	14.5	14.5	28.0	See A.3.2	
2 676 to 3 450	23.0	15.5	15.5	30.5	See A.3.2	
3 451 to 4 350	24.0	16.0	16.0	32.0	See A.3.2	
4 351 to 5 450	25.0	16.5	16.5	33.5	See A.3.2	
5 451 to 6 800	26.0	17.5	17.5	34.5	See A.3.2	
6 801 to 8 500	27.0	18.0	18.0	36.0	See A.3.2	
8 501 to 10 700	28.0	18.5	18.5	37.5	See A.3.2	
> 10 700	Follow progression above	Follow progression above	Follow progression above	Follow progression above	See A.3.2	

A.3.2 Factors for adjustment of audit time

The time allocated shall also consider the following factors that relate to the complexity of a client's AIMS and therefore to the effort needed to audit the organization:

- number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope;
- number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope;
- number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope;

- d) number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope;
- e) number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS.

To determine the total audit time, all applicable factors for adjustment listed in a) to e) shall be applied for the specific AIMS.

[Annex B](#) provides examples how these different factors can be considered when calculating audit time.

A.3.3 On-site audit time

On-site audit time refers to the on-site audit time allocated for individual sites.

It is expected that the time calculated for planning and report writing combined should not typically reduce the total on-site “audit time” (physical/remote) to less than 70 % of the time calculated in accordance with [A.3.1](#) and [A.3.2](#). Where additional time is required for planning and / or report writing, this shall not be a justification for reducing on-site audit time. Auditor travel time is not included in this calculation and is additional to the total audit time calculated in accordance with [A.3.1](#) and [A.3.2](#).

NOTE 1 70 % is based on experience with information security management system (ISMS) audits.

NOTE 2 The term “(physical/remote)” means that “on site” audits (for physical locations or electronic sites of the client) can be conducted physically or remotely (see [9.2.4](#) and [A.2.4](#)). For “on-site” audits, see also ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.4.1.

A.4 Audit time for surveillance audit and client monitoring

For the initial certification audit cycle, surveillance time for a given organization should be proportional to the time spent at initial certification audit with the total amount of time spent annually on surveillance being about 1/3 of the time spent on the initial certification audit. The planned surveillance time should be reviewed occasionally to account for changes that affect audit time. The time spent on a surveillance audit shall be increased to allow for the audit changes in the AIMS (such as but not limited to the audit of new or changed AIMS controls, processes and services).

In addition to the usual surveillance cycle, the certification body shall reach an agreement with its client to regulate additional surveillance of the client’s own monitoring activities, if the AIMS manages AI systems classified as high-risk or applied within sensitive purposes (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.). This can include additional audits or an agreement on the provision of parameters that can cause extraordinary surveillance measures by the certification body.

Parameters shall be set in a way that they indicate changes to certification-relevant criteria of the AI system monitored by the AIMS. In the event of a change indicated by those parameters for which the certified client takes measures, the certification body shall assess if additional surveillance measures for the AIMS of the client are necessary.

A.5 Audit time for re-certification audit

The total amount of time spent performing the re-certification audit shall depend upon the results of any prior audit as defined in [9.6.3](#). The audit time for a re-certification should be proportional to, but at least two thirds of, the audit time required for an initial certification audit of the same organization at the time of the re-certification audit.

A.6 Deviation from audit time calculation

To ensure that audits are effective and to ensure reliable and comparable results, the total audit time (including the applicable factors for adjustment of audit time) calculated in [Table A.1](#) should be considered a minimum.

The factors for adjustment of audit time (see [A.3.2](#)) depend on the client’s AIMS and have to be selected on a case-by-case basis by the certification body to determine the final audit time for an initial certification audit.

The numbers of auditor days in [Table A.1](#) cannot be used alone, without any consideration of the adjustment factors of audit time. Appropriate reasons for deviation shall be described and documented.

A.7 Audit time of multi-site

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 9.1.5 apply.

A.8 Audit time for scope extensions

The audit time required to extend the scope of an AIMS shall be calculated based on the following factors:

- a) the type of extension;
- b) the activity or activities of the current certification;
- c) the number of locations where the activity or activities take(s) place;
- d) the related AI system(s) risks related to the activity or activities that are managed within the AIMS;
- e) the number of controls relevant to the extension;
- f) the number of persons involved in the AI life cycle of the extended scope;
- g) the time required to review the integration of the extended scope into the AIMS.

The certification body shall have procedures that provides a consistent approach to extension of the scope.

For the initial certification audit of the extended scope, the time shall be calculated based on the number of persons involved in the AI life cycle and the factors for adjustment of audit time, both being added to the already existing scope using [A.3.1](#) and [A.3.2](#).

Audit time shall be added to the calculated duration to review the certified client running its AIMS. This additional time shall be at least:

- half auditor day if the extension to scope audit is conducted in conjunction with a surveillance audit or a re-certification audit;
- one auditor day when the extension to the scope audit is conducted as a separate audit.

NOTE The application to different sectors potentially lead to differences in the calculation of audit times.

Annex B (informative)

Examples for audit time calculations

B.1 General

This Annex provides further guidelines and examples on determining audit time based on the criteria outlined in normative [Annex A](#).

This Annex outlines two different approaches as guidance and as examples on how to determine audit time.

B.2 Guidelines and examples on determination of audit time based on audit time for initial audit and the factors for adjustment of audit time

B.2.1 Option A

B.2.1.1 Classification of factors for the adjustment of audit time

[Table B.1](#) gives examples for the classification of factors for adjustment of audit time (see [A.3.2](#)) as additive factors to the calculated audit time for initial audit in [Table A.1](#). This classification can be used by a certification body as guideline and to derive an audit time calculation scheme in line with [9.1.4](#).

Table B.1 — Classification of factors for adjustment of audit time

Factors for adjustment of audit time	Classification of factors for adjustment of audit time	
	Impact on effort	
	Normal effort (only audit time for initial audit)	Increased effort (additional time needed to audit time for initial audit)
Number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope	Only one regulatory framework to be managed within an AIMS	More than one regulatory framework to be managed within an AIMS
Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope	— Few or only one AI system within an AIMS scope; — Similar AI systems managed within AIMS scope.	— Medium or high amount of AI systems within an AIMS scope; — Different AI systems managed within AIMS scope.
Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope		Additive time needed, e.g. for: — Necessary assessment of additional documentation due to high-risk or sensitive purpose; — Complex data and/or data that already contain sensitive information (e.g. personally identifiable information); — Additional languages in use; — Extent of the managed AI system(s) effects on individuals, groups of individuals and societies in its applied context; — Extent of the managed AI system(s) effects on its applied context.
Number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope	Non or few third-party agreements within AIMS scope	If AIMS manages medium or high amount of third-party agreements within AIMS scope (e.g. more than five third-party agreements need additive audit time)
Number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1		— Additional controls beyond the mentioned in ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1 — Extent of high complexity and additional documentation due to the controls documented in the SoA.
For surveillance or re-certification audit		
the amount and extent of change relevant to the AIMS in accordance with ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, 8.5.3	— Minor changes in scope or SoA of AIMS, e.g. some policies, documents; — Minor changes in the factors above.	— Major changes in scope or SoA of AIMS, e.g. new processes, new business units, areas, risk assessment management, methodology, policies, documentation, risk treatment; — Major changes in the adjustment factors.

Table B.2 — Determination of audit time of factors for adjustment of audit time

Factors for adjustment of audit time	Additive audit time for increased effort	Total audit time (audit time for initial audit plus additive audit time for increased effort)
	Auditor days (auditor days, d)	
Number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope (per additional framework)	1.0	See Table A.1 for audit time for initial audit plus applicable audit time of factors for the adjustment of audit time in A.3.2 and Table B.1
Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope (per additional AI system exceeding five AI systems covered in audit time for initial audit)	1.0 to 2.0	See Table A.1 for audit time for initial audit plus applicable audit time of factors for the adjustment of audit time in A.3.2 and Table B.1
Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope (per additional different types/methods of AI systems)	0.5 to 1.0	See Table A.1 for audit time for initial audit plus applicable audit time of factors for the adjustment of audit time in A.3.2 and Table B.1
Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope (per high-risk AI system and/or per additional sensitive purpose AI system)	0.5 to 2.0	See Table A.1 for audit time for initial audit plus applicable audit time of factors for the adjustment of audit time in A.3.2 and Table B.1
Number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope (per additional third-party agreement, exceeding five agreements covered in audit time for initial audit)	0.1 (max. 2.0)	See Table A.1 for audit time for initial audit plus applicable audit time of factors for the adjustment of audit time in A.3.2 and Table B.1
Number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1 (per additional control)	0.1 (max. 2.0)	See Table A.1 for audit time for initial audit plus applicable audit time of factors for the adjustment of audit time in A.3.2 and Table B.1

B.2.1.2 Examples for audit time calculation

The following examples illustrate how a certification body may use the audit time for initial audit in [Table A.1](#) and the applicable factors for adjustment of audit time in [A.3.2](#) with the guidance given in [Table B.1](#) and the guidance on the additional audit time to be added in [Table B.2](#) to calculate audit time. The calculation of audit time in the examples below works in the following way:

Step 1: Determination of the correct audit time for initial audit according to [A.3.1](#) and [Table A.1](#).

Step 2: Determination of applicable factors for the adjustment of audit time according to [A.3.2](#). Identify the suitable factors based on the given information by the client and its statement of applicability (SoA) and identify the additional audit time based on [Table B.2](#) with the guidance of [Table B.1](#).

Step 3: The total audit time is calculated based on Step 1 and Step 2.

If necessary, identify further factors that need to be considered and document them. If the auditor days given in [Table B.2](#) for the factors of adjustment of audit time are not applicable or need to be extended, document the considerations for the exclusion or the extension.

Example 1:

The organization under audit is an AI producer as defined in ISO/IEC 22989 and the certification body determined 125 employees involved in the AI life cycle. The organization has one AI system. This is documented in the SoA of the organization. Further, the organization uses the AI system in a sensitive automotive context. The data to train the model of the AI producer partially come from two different service providers. The organization operates within two, highly regulated, regulatory frameworks (e.g. Japan and EU). Therefore, it has two additional controls beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Table A.1 implemented regarding the automotive context.

Step 1: The certification body uses [Table A.1](#) to determine the audit time for initial audit. For organization's that have 125 employees involved in the AI life cycle and the role is defined as AI producer, the baseline audit time is twelve auditor days.

Step 2: The factors for adjustment of audit time in [A.3.2](#) apply as follows to this client:

- Number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope: two regulatory frameworks;
- Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope: one AI system;
- Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope: one sensitive purpose (automotive);
- Number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope: two third-party agreements;
- Number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Table A.1: two additional controls beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Table A.1.

By checking the factors for adjustment time and use as guideline [Table B.1](#), additional audit time to be able to assess those factors is needed on top of the audit time for initial audit determined in [Table A.1](#).

Taking [Table B.1](#) and [B.2](#) into consideration for the determination of audit time. For number of regulatory frameworks, one additional auditor day is needed for one additional regulatory framework. Since there is only one AI system managed within the AIMS, no additional time is necessary on top of the audit time for initial audit. Since, the AI system operates within a sensitive automotive context, but one sensitive context is covered in the audit time for initial audit as long as the AI system itself is not a high-risk/sensitive function, no additional auditor day is needed. With only two third-party agreements, no additional time is needed to check those agreements. The AIMS covers two additional controls, which need extra audit time. Based on [Table B.2](#), this would add additional 0.2 auditor days.

Based on the expert assessment of the client's application and information this would lead to an additional adding of $1+0.2 = 1.2$ auditor days.

Step 3: With the audit time for initial audit determined in [Table A.1](#) of twelve auditor days, and the adding of 1,2 auditor days due to the factors for adjustment of audit time, the total audit time would equal 13,2 auditor days.

Example 2:

The organization to be audited is an AI user as defined in ISO/IEC 22989. It is a big company with 10 500 employees, two company locations in Australia and Spain as well as two official working languages. The certification body determined 427 employees as being involved in the AI life cycle. There is one AI system managed by the AIMS and this AI system is used by all of the employees to track the working times and efficiency based on certain criteria. Since personal rights are affected, the AI system is used in a sensitive area however, it does not have any additional controls beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1. The AI system is procured by one provider based on a third-party agreement.

Step 1: The certification body uses [Table A.1](#) to determine the audit time for initial audit. For organization's that have 427 employees involved in the AI life cycle but is only an AI user, the baseline audit time is eleven auditor days.

Step 2: The factors for adjustment of audit time in [A.3.2](#) apply as follows to this client:

- Number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope: two regulatory frameworks;
- Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope: one AI system;
- Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope: one sensitive purpose (personal rights);
- Number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope: one third-party agreement;
- Number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Table A.1: no additional controls.

By checking the factors for adjustment time and use as guideline [Table B.1](#), additional audit time to be able to assess those factors is needed on top of the audit time for initial audit determined in [Table A.1](#).

Taking [Table B.1](#) and [B.2](#) into consideration for the determination of audit time. One additional auditor day is needed for the second regulatory framework. One sensitive purpose is covered by the audit time for initial audit and since the AI system itself is not a high-risk system or has sensitive function, no additional time is needed. Also, the adjustment factors about third-party agreements and number of additional controls are not applicable since this is already covered in the audit time for initial audit.

Based on the expert assessment of the client's application and information this would lead to an additional adding of one auditor day.

Step 3: With the audit time for initial audit determined in [Table A.1](#) of eleven auditor days, and the adding of one auditor days due to the factors for adjustment of audit time, the total audit time would equal twelve auditor days.

Example 3:

The organization to be audited is an AI developer and AI user as defined in ISO/IEC 22989 and works within the highly regulated medical device sector. It has multiple roles. The organization develops and uses its AI system that is classified as high-risk or sensitive which is based on image recognition methods and deep neural networks. The organization has five employees involved in the AI life cycle process and operates in three regulatory frameworks. The organization has eight outsourced service providers in the scope of the AIMS and manages five controls beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1 in order to fulfil the different regulatory framework requirements.

Step 1: The certification body uses [Table A.1](#) to determine the audit time for initial audit. With five employees, the baseline audit time is 6,5 auditor days for an organization with multiple roles.

Step 2: The factors for adjustment of audit time in [A.3.2](#) apply as follows to this client:

- Number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope: three regulatory frameworks;
- Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope: one AI system with two different types;
- Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope: one high-risk AI system and one sensitive purpose;
- Number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope: eight third-party agreements;
- Number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1: five additional controls beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1.

By checking the factors for adjustment time and use as guideline [Table B.1](#), additional audit time to be able to assess those factors is needed on top of the audit time for initial audit determined in [Table A.1](#).

Taking [Table B.1](#) and [B.2](#) into consideration for the determination of audit time. Two additional auditor days are needed for the two additive regulatory frameworks. With an additional second type of AI system that is especially complex, one additional auditor day is needed to assess the AIMS. With only one sensitive purpose, no additional audit time is needed for this factor. However, eight third-party agreements need additive audit time. Based on [Table B.2](#) an addition of 0,3 auditor days is necessary as well as with five additional controls another 0.5 additional auditor day is needed.

Based on the expert assessment of the client's application and information this would lead to an additional adding of $2+1+0.3+0.5 = 3.8$ auditor days.

Step 3: With the audit time for initial audit determined in [Table A.1](#) of 6.5 auditor days, and the adding of 3.8 auditor days due to the factors for adjustment of audit time, the total audit time would equal 10.3 auditor days.

B.2.2 Option B

B.2.2.1 Classification of factors for the adjustment of audit time

[Table B.3](#) provides examples for classification of the main factors for calculation of audit time as listed in [A.3.2](#). a) to e). This classification can be used by certification bodies to derive an audit time calculation scheme in line with [9.1.4](#).

Table B.3 — Classification for audit time calculation of factors for adjustment of audit time

Factors for adjustment of audit time (see A.3.2)	Classification for audit time calculation		
	Reduced effort (time subtracted from audit time of initial audit in Table A.1)	Normal effort (audit time of initial audit in Table A.1)	Additional effort (additional time needed to audit time of initial audit)
Number of regulatory framework(s) within an AIMS scope	Organization is not subject to regulatory frameworks	Only one regulatory framework to be managed within an AIMS	More than one regulatory framework to be managed within an AIMS
Number of AI system(s) within an AIMS scope	Low number of AI systems within an AIMS scope	Medium number of AI systems within an AIMS scope	High number of AI systems within an AIMS scope
Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope		No systems in scope used for high risk or sensitive purposes	One or more systems in scope used for high risk or sensitive purposes
Number of third-party agreement(s) within AIMS scope	— No outsourcing and little dependency on suppliers; or — Well-defined, managed and monitored outsourcing arrangements; — Third-party has a certified AIMS; — Relevant independent assurance reports are available.	Several partly managed outsourcing arrangements	— High dependency on outsourcing or suppliers with large impact on important business activities; or — Unknown amount or extent of outsourcing; or — Several unmanaged outsourcing arrangements.
Number of control(s) as documented in the statement of applicability (SoA) of an AIMS beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1	Fewer controls than mentioned in ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1 (some common control areas not included, e.g. no systems development controls)	Controls in ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1	Additional controls beyond those mentioned in ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1

B.2.2.2 Example for audit time calculation

The factors below may be used to determine audit time.

The following example illustrates how a certification body may use the factors provided in A.3 to calculate audit time. The calculation of audit time in the example below works in the following way:

Step 1: Determination of factors related to business and organization (other than AI systems): Identify the suitable grade for each of the categories given in Table B.4 and sum up the results.

Step 2: Determination of factors related to AI systems: Identify the suitable grade for each of the categories given in Table B.5 and sum up the results.

Step 3: Based on the results of steps 1 and 2 above, identify the impact of factors on audit time by selecting the appropriate entry in Table B.6.

Step 4: Final calculation: The number of days determined by applying the audit time for the initial audit chart (Table A.1) is multiplied by the factor resulting from Step 3. Where multi-site sampling is utilized, the audit days calculated are increased based on the efforts needed to execute the multi-site sampling plan.

This result is the final number of audit days.

Table B.4 — Factors related to business and organization (other than AI systems)

Category	Grade
Type(s) of business and regulatory frameworks	1. Organization works in non-critical business sectors and nonregulated sectors; 2. Organization works in regulated business sectors; 3. Organization works in critical or highly regulated business sectors.
Number of controls implemented beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1	1. Fewer controls; 2. All controls; 3. Additional controls.

Table B.5 — Factors related to AI Systems

Category	Grade
System complexity (number of AI systems within an AIMS scope)	1. Relative to the size of the organization, there are a small number of AI systems in scope; 2. Relative to the size of the organization, there are a medium number of AI systems in scope; 3. Relative to the size of the organization, there are a large number of AI systems in scope.
Whether any systems in use are sensitive/used for high-risk purposes (Number of high-risk or sensitive purpose (e.g. health; safety critical; affecting personal rights; etc.) AI system(s) within AIMS scope)	1. NA; 2. Organization uses no systems for sensitive or high-risk purposes; 3. Organization uses one or more systems for high risk purposes.
Dependency on outsourcing and suppliers (number of third party agreement(s))	1. Little or no dependency on outsourcing or suppliers; 2. Some dependency on outsourcing or suppliers, related to some, but not all, important business activities; 3. High dependency on outsourcing or suppliers, large impact on important business activities.

Table B.6 — Impact of factors on audit time

		AI System (Table B.5)		
		Low (from 3 to 4)	Medium (from 5 to 7)	High (from 8 to 9)
Business (Table B.4)	High (from 5 to 6)	+5 % to +20 %	+10 % to +50 %	+20 % to +100 %
	Medium (from 3 to 4)	-5 % to -10 %	0 %	+10 % to +50 %
	Low (2)	-10 % to -30 %	-5 % to -10 %	+5 % to +20 %

EXAMPLE 1:

The certification body determined 125 employees as being involved in the AI life cycle across all the locations of the organization in scope to be audited and is an AI producer. Thus, according to [Table A.1](#), twelve auditor days are required for the initial audit. The organization works in a regulated business sector and has additional controls beyond ISO/IEC 42001:2023, Annex A, Table A.1 implemented. According to [Table B.4](#), this would yield a factor related to business and organization of $2+3=5$.

The organization has only two AI systems in scope which is considered low for an organization of their size, but one is considered used for sensitive purposes, and they utilize several managed outsourcing arrangements. According to [Table B.5](#) this would yield a factor related to AI systems of $1+3+2=6$.

Using [Table B.6](#) this would yield to an adjustment for the audit time in between 10 % to 50 %.

Annex C (informative)

Template for a certification document

C.1 General

The certification documents for an AIMS demonstrates conformance with the content of the template in [C.2](#). The certification body can display the information as it suits itself.

C.2 Certificate text for this document

Certification Body Logo and
address

Certificate

The certification body [_____] hereby confirms as a result of the certification decision on
[YYYY-MM-DD] according to ISO/IEC 17021-1 that the

[Certified organization]: <exact name and address of the client>

[optional locations] <address of branch offices or subsidiaries>

a

Management System according to ISO/IEC 42001:2023

SoA Version XXX

for the scope

***[description of the scope for which the organization running the AIMS
has been certified, if applicable Appendix 1]***

operates in compliance with the requirements of ISO/IEC 42001:2023 (and this certified organization running the AIMS has fulfilled the additional requirements of the *[designation of additional requirement]*) and is monitored by the certification body during the term of the certificate.

This certificate does not authorize the labelling of products or services.

-- Optional --Commencement

This certificate entitles the certified organization to use the following conformity mark *[exact name of the conformity mark in the sense of ISO/IEC 17030^[4]]* under the conditions of the conformity assessment programme for the duration of the certification:

ISO/IEC 42006:2025(en)

Logo conformity mark

-- Optional --End

Conformity assessment scheme: [name of the certification scheme and version/rev. xxx]

Certificate ID / Number: XXX certificate number of certification body

Last audit day on site: <YYYY-MM-DD> /report number/date

First surveillance: first planned surveillance by no later than <YYYY-MM-DD>.

Date of issue: <YYYY-MM-DD> Duration until <YYYY-MM-DD> maximum 3 years>.

Signature/named decision maker of the certification body

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- [4] ISO/IEC 17030, *Conformity assessment — General requirements for third-party marks of conformity*
- [5] ISO 19011, *Guidelines for auditing management systems*
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